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New security rules set at Tewksbury Hospital

Ban on pepper gel, other defensive tools seen as safety threat by some

By Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

The mounting tensions inside Massachusetts state hospitals, which are treating greater numbers of mentally ill patients accused of crimes, were underscored in an incident last year when a security worker at Tewksbury Hospital used a form of pepper spray to subdue a patient.

The patient had already injured one worker and engaged in a 25-minute standoff in the Sept. 30 incident before a security worker hit him with pepper gel, an irritant using oleoresin capicum derived from chili peppers.

The episode has triggered a debate over security protocols at the institution, where an overhaul of procedures last year was intended to address violence and incidences of patients leaving without permission and going into the surrounding residential neighborhoods.

Now, the Tewksbury facility is barring security staff from using an array of defensive tools, including pepper gel, handcuffs, and batons, its chief executive on Thursday saying they are inappropriate in a hospital setting.

“Tewksbury Hospital is a place of healing,” the CEO, Amy Dumont, wrote in a letter outlining the new policy. “Every decision we make, from how we care for our patients to how we design our spaces to how we train our staff,

TEWKSBURY, Page A7

Vt. news site seeks stability as it grows

VTDigger started strong, now it faces challenges

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

Over the course of nearly two decades, VTDigger built itself into one of the scrappy success stories of nonprofit digital news — growing to fill the gap left by Vermont’s vanishing local and regional outlets.

But VTDigger, now 30 staffers strong and one of the state’s premier news sources, finds itself set back by editorial departures and ongoing financial losses.

The organization has been operating in the red since just before its founder left in 2022, and the chief executive who succeeded her is now leaving. Meanwhile, VTDigger is in the market for its third top editor in just over a year after a bruising contract negotiation with the newsroom union.

The challenges at the acclaimed newsroom have sounded alarm bells: “Is VTDigger In Trouble?” local journalist John Walters asked in a column earlier this year. “I see many troubling signs, and I am concerned.”

But current executives argue the organization is on sound financial and editorial footing

VTDIGGER, Page A7

Bondi is out as attorney general

Trump loyalist fired amid president’s frustration over handling of Epstein files

By Tyler Pager
and Glenn Thrush
NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump fired Attorney General Pam Bondi on Thursday, removing the nation’s top law enforcement officer after privately venting his frustrations for months over her handling of the Epstein files and her failed efforts to prosecute his political enemies.

In a social media post, Trump said he was replacing Bondi with Todd Blanche, her deputy, on an interim basis.

“We love Pam, and she will be transitioning to a much needed and important new job in the private sector, to be announced at a date in the near future,” Trump wrote.

Bondi is the second Cabinet member in recent weeks to lose her



ALEX BRANDON/AP/FILE

Pam Bondi is the second Cabinet member to lose her job in recent weeks, after Kristi Noem was

job, after Trump ousted Kristi Noem, the secretary of homeland security, last month.

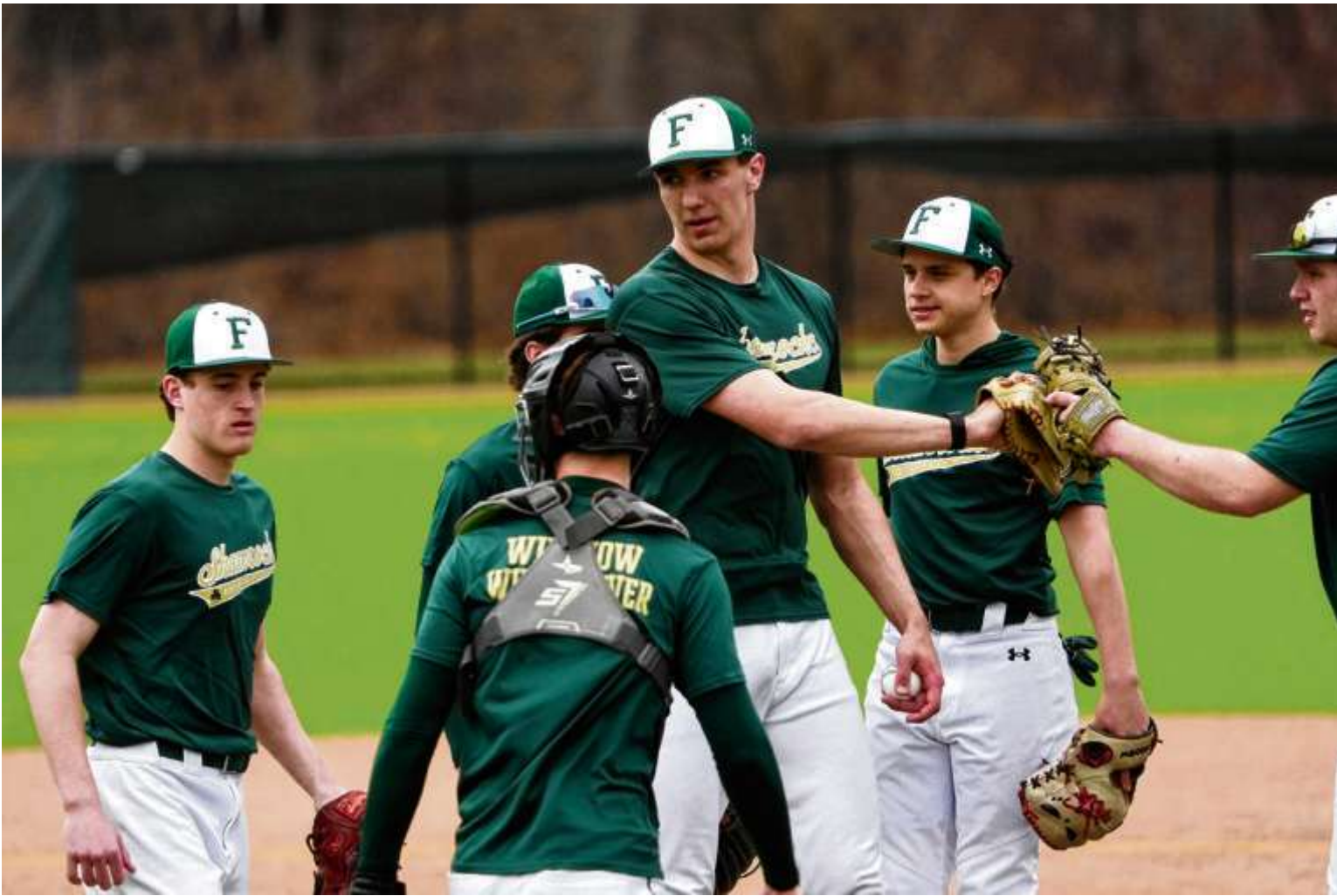
The firing of Bondi, 60, ends a turbulent 14-month tenure as attorney general in which she tried desperately to appease a boss who demanded unimpeded control of the Justice Department to pursue politically motivated investigations against targets of his choosing, even when prosecutors warned that there was no evidence to do so.

In the process, Bondi surrendered

BONDI, Page A5

A pitching catch

Feehan senior has size and speed — and the eye of MLB scouts



PHOTOS BY BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Brody Bumila is a 6-foot-9-inch, 250-pound, 18-year-old lefthander whose fastball can reach triple digits.



Bumila led Bishop Feehan to the Division 1 state basketball title, and the next day returned to the pitching mound.

By Matt Porter
GLOBE STAFF

ATTLEBORO — First pitch was minutes away. The starting pitcher was done warming. The loudspeakers at Bishop Feehan were pumping Kesha’s 2010 club anthem, “We R Who We R.”

Brody Bumila exited the home bullpen and strutted toward his waiting teammates like he was in a music video.

“Hot and dangerous, if you’re one of us then roll with us,” lip-synched the biggest kid on campus. “You don’t wanna mess with us, got Jesus on my necklace.”

With elevated levels of size, swagger, and studiousness, Bumila has major league teams watching his every move this spring. The Raynham native averaged 42 points and 20 rebounds in Feehan’s surprise run to a Division 1 basketball state championship, but pro baseball front offices are rubbernecking at these numbers:

He is a 6-foot-9-inch, 250-pound, 18-year-old lefthander whose smoothly delivered fastball touches 101 miles per hour.

“The ceiling is as high as humanly possible for a high school prospect,” said his agent, Alex Ott, who calls it a

‘He was a great young man. ... Everyone knew he was great.’

JULIO GARCIA MAZARA, uncle of Enrique Delgado-Garcia

Dead police recruit boxed with toughest cadet



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

State Police Sergeant Jennifer Penton (center) and Trooper David Montanez (right) after their arraignment.

Details revealed as supervisors appear in court

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

It was the day before “boxing day” at the State Police academy in September 2024, and none of the other cadets wanted to warm up with a fight against the most skilled, toughest recruit in the class. The only trainee willing was Enrique Delgado-Garcia. He ended up with concussion-like symptoms in the unauthorized, unsupervised sparring practice.

The next day, they again

paired him with the same recruit. And again, he suffered severe blows to the head and was knocked down multiple times until eventually, according to prosecutors, he could not get back up. He was taken to the hospital, where he later died.

Meanwhile, prosecutors said, supervisors at the academy changed records about the two sparring sessions, inaccurately describing both days’ events.

Those details were disclosed in court documents Thursday as three of the supervisors appeared in court for the first time on manslaughter charges relat-

RECRUIT, Page A6

A federal commission approved President Trump’s planned White House ballroom, but the project’s future remains uncertain. **A2.**

French President Emmanuel Macron lashed out at President Trump for what he said was an unserious approach to the war in Iran. **A3.**

A housing court jury found a Somerville renter was legally living in his apartment, while also determining that his landlord did not retaliate against him. **B1.**

The second building in the long-planned \$1.4 billion overhaul of Charlestown’s sprawling Bunker Hill public housing complex will break ground this spring after the project landed a \$122 million construction loan. **B5.**



Spring, a leak

Friday: Drizzle early, then sun. High: 60-65. Low: 50-55.

Saturday: Cloudy, breezy. High: 54-59. Low: 36-41.

Sunrise: 6:23 Sunset: 7:12

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